Chapter-wise Detailed Notes — Parliament: composition, powers and functions

Indian Government & Politics · Unit 4 · Chapter Parliament: composition, powers and functions

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Chapter Study Notes

Learning focus

Parliament consists of the President, Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha. The two Houses have different membership structures and roles.

1. Parliament legislates, approves taxation and expenditure, debates public issues, amends the Constitution under prescribed procedures and holds the executive accountable.

2. Committees examine bills, budgets and administrative work in greater detail than is usually possible in full House sittings.

3. The Lok Sabha is directly elected and central to government confidence. The Rajya Sabha is a continuing House and represents states and Union Territories through its constitutional design.

4. Effective parliamentary government depends on deliberation, opposition scrutiny, committee work, attendance and access to reliable information.

Revision checklist

■ Can I define the key concept in my own words?

■ Can I explain its main features and distinguish it from related concepts?

■ Can I support an argument with a relevant example, thinker or constitutional provision?

■ Can I discuss at least one limitation or counterargument?